

THE AI STARTUP VALIDATION BOARD: FROM GUESSING TO TESTING

STOP GUESSING. START TESTING BEHAVIOR, NOT OPINIONS.

Project Name

LifeAdmin AI

Group Members

Session 11 Workshop

THE AI HYPOTHESIS STACK

CUSTOMER HYPOTHESIS

Busy professionals and students (25-40) juggling multiple providers (landlords, insurers, universities, subscriptions) with no single system to track deadlines or paperwork.

PROBLEM HYPOTHESIS

People miss 2-4 cancellation or renewal deadlines a year (roughly EUR 150-300 wasted) and spend 3+ hours a month reading documents and writing formal emails.

SOLUTION & UX HYPOTHESIS

AI summarizes complex documents instantly, proactively flags deadlines, and drafts ready-to-send emails, turning a multi-step task into a one-tap approval.

AI TECHNICAL HYPOTHESIS

Can the model reliably extract accurate dates, terms and obligations from varied real documents across languages without hallucinating deadlines or clauses.

DESIGN EXPERIMENT

STEP 1: THE RISKIEST ASSUMPTION

Leap of Faith - Select ONE hypothesis that kills the startup if false: Users will trust an AI to autonomously read their personal documents and emails and act on their behalf (drafting/sending cancellation emails) without doing it manually themselves.

STEP 2: EXPERIMENT PLAN

Test Level	Concierge (Wizard of Oz)
Description	Manually 'be the AI': users send one real contract or subscription document; we summarize it and draft an email within 24h. Fast & cheap, under 2 weeks.
Method	Landing page + short form collecting a real document upload, with a human-powered back end simulating the AI response.
Minimum Success Criterion	At least 40% of landing page visitors upload a document, and at least 70% approve the drafted email as-is or with minor edits.

RESULTS & VALIDATION LAB

Validated

Invalidated

What specific data confirms the hypothesis: e.g. 12 of 18 users uploaded a real document, and 8 of 12 approved the drafted email without edits.

Invalidated

What data proves it wrong: e.g. users uploaded documents but refused to let the AI send emails automatically - trust breaks at the autonomous-action step, not the reading step.

A great AI startup learns fastest what is false

IDEA

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HYPOTHESIS

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EXPERIMENT

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NEXT TEST

THE DECISION LOOP

ITERATE

Adjust metrics or prompt, test again

Upload rate is fine but email trust is low: keep explain and draft, require manual send, retest.

PIVOT

Change a major hypothesis

Users only want documents explained, not deadlines tracked or emails sent: narrow to a document simplifier.

KILL

Acknowledge failure and move on

Fewer than 20% will upload a real, sensitive document to an unfamiliar startup: core data-access assumption fails.